



**Dr. Devi Shetty**  
Founder & Chairman,  
Narayana Health

PHOTO BY **SELVAPRAKASH LAKSHMANAN**

country was growing. When the sea level rises, big ships go up, and so do the small boats.”

Today, Narayana Health operates a network of 42 healthcare facilities in India, with 5,098 operational beds. And it is now looking to expand abroad.

### **A MODEST START**

Shetty's first hospital, Rabindranath Tagore International Institute of Cardiac Sciences in Kolkata, opened its doors in 2000. The project began with a modest investment of ₹1.6 lakh. “It was a small beginning, but our goal was clear—we wanted to deliver world-class heart care at a fraction of the cost,” he recalls.

Encouraged by the response, Shetty established Narayana Health in 2001, starting with a 225-bed cardiac hospital in Bengaluru.

Narayana Health's ability to reduce costs without compromising on quality set it apart. By performing a high volume of surgeries and streamlining operations, it slashed prices dramatically. For example, the cost of a heart surgery at Narayana Health is ₹1.5-2 lakh, while the same procedure could cost up to ₹30 lakh in the US.

This was backed by an aggressive investment in technology. “From day one, we knew that the future of healthcare was digital,” says Shetty. While other hospitals were still transitioning to digital records, Narayana